

Synthesize Across Sources

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

Source A: The east classroom wing is hottest after noon. Source B: Portable shades can be installed there before next month; permanent trees will take years to provide full shade.

Task: Which conclusion uses both sources?

- A. Portable shade could address the hottest wing sooner while longer-term shade develops.
- B. Trees are always better than portable shade.
- C. The west wing is hottest.
- D. No action is possible.

Exercise 2

Source A: Most missed appointments occur on Monday mornings. Source B: Reminder messages are currently sent only the evening before appointments.

Task: Which combined question would be most useful to investigate next?

- A. Whether earlier or additional reminders reduce Monday morning misses.
- B. What color the clinic walls are.
- C. Whether Tuesday has a name.
- D. How many chairs are in the lobby.

Exercise 3

Source A: A bridge repair will take four months if fully closed. Source B: The detour adds 18 minutes for school buses.

Task: Which conclusion is supported by both?

- A. A full closure would create a substantial transportation impact for school buses.
- B. The bridge should never be repaired.
- C. All drivers use school buses.
- D. The detour is shorter than the normal route.

Exercise 4

Source A: Survey respondents prefer more weekend library hours. Source B: Saturday usage is much higher than Sunday usage.

Task: Which plan is best supported?

- A. Test additional Saturday hours before assuming both weekend days need the same extension.
- B. Extend Sunday only because it is less busy.
- C. Close on Saturday.
- D. Make a permanent seven-day schedule immediately.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. Portable shade could address the hottest wing sooner while longer-term shade develops.

Why: It combines the location finding from Source A with the timing information from Source B.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. Whether earlier or additional reminders reduce Monday morning misses.

Why: It uses the timing pattern from one source and the current reminder process from the other.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. A full closure would create a substantial transportation impact for school buses.

Why: The repair duration and detour time together show a prolonged impact.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Test additional Saturday hours before assuming both weekend days need the same extension.

Why: The survey supports more weekend access while the usage pattern suggests Saturday is the stronger starting point.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.